



Google algorithm to help HR

Will mine employee data to find those most likely to quit

a touch screen ranging from 7- to 10-inches and should retail in a price range of \$500 to \$700. Such a machine would be placed in the high-end netbook bracket. People have always been willing to pay for Apple's products. Nevertheless, it still needs to be functional and practical. The product will certainly make the Apple lineup more complete. As of now, there is nothing between the Macbook at one end, and the iPod and iPhone, at the other. There are also reports that Apple is working on a tablet-like full touch device. If this is the same gadget then it'll need a Bluetooth keyboard as an attachment. People won't really be comfortable typing on a virtual touch keyboard when it comes to netbooks. Consumers perceive Apple products as better constructed and so will sink in money if



the netbook gadget is their second or third PC.

10,000 GB on DVD in 5 years

While doing the hard disk test last month, we were wondering whatever happened to the sci-fi like holographic storage medium that was supposed to be just around the corner. Now it seems there is a DVD being developed that's based on nano technology dubbed ultra-DVD that can store 10 TB in a single disk. Currently, Blu-ray disks that hold 50 GB are not even close to the projected capacity of these ultra-DVDs. Scientists working on the project say the DVD could be available to consumers as early as five years from now. It will surely change the way we view and even perceive digital data, and even

entertainment. Its outcome could include things such as three dimensional video and some ultra-HD viewing. The scientists working on the project say that nano-structured material can be incorporated on to a disc to increase data capacity without increasing the size of the disk.

Meanwhile, another study is also under way in Australia that is looking at developing five dimensional DVDs. Researchers have already designed a five-dimensional DVD that can store 1.6 TB of data on a standard-size DVD. That is as much as 30 Blu-ray disks! Unlike normal DVDs that have two layers of stacked data these disks have an additional 3 layers – one data and two for reading wavelength and polarisation. The layers will be made of thin glass films and will be coated with gold nano rods with three different sizes. To record

data on the disk a laser is focused on the nano rods. Each nano rod melts at different wavelengths into spheres. This change of state denotes the change from 1 to 0. The researchers are currently working with Samsung

to make the technology commercially viable, but it could take anywhere between five to ten years. The challenge is that since the data is so densely packed, reading it at high speeds will pose a problem. Also, currently a very large and not to mention expensive titanium-sapphire femto-second laser is being used in the study. A cheaper laser will have to be developed.

Speed racers can't speed no more

A new system has been developed in London UK called the Intelligent Speed Adaptation. Don't let the name impress you. What this system does is it actually regulates the speed of your vehicle; if connected. This device uses satellites to track the vehicle

STAIR cell

A new air-fueled battery is being developed that could store almost 10 times more power. This would mean a tremendous breakthrough in portable electronics and it would also add to being a renewable resource

and a digital roadmap to pinpoint the position of the vehicle and at the same time find out the speed limit of that area. Once determined, it prevents the driver from accelerating further than the speed limit.

The implementation of this system is good and bad at the same time. Good, because its success will reduce the number of accidents caused due to speeding. However, speed demons will be really disappointed if this becomes compulsory for all vehicles. As of now, this technology is being implemented for taxis, buses and council vehicles.

The technology is supposed to go on sale some time next year for private car owners. We do see parents fitting their vehicles with this device so that their teenage children don't go over the speed limit, but veteran drivers won't really prefer these extra regulations.

Hubble upgrade

The Hubble space telescope which has been helping mankind get a better understanding of the universe for 19 years, was in serious need of an overhaul. A seven member crew flew aboard the space shuttle Atlantis this month to give the orbiting telescope its fifth and final repair. The mission lasted 13 days and began by first pulling the telescope to the shuttle's payload bay. Then the crew needed five spacewalks to replace the telescope's batteries, gyroscopes, data-handling unit and added a host of new instruments such as a new camera and spectrograph. The mission turned out to be tricky, say some reports, because although the telescope is installed in space, it was not designed to be fixed there. Once the crew was done



with the repairs and upgrades, astronauts used the Canadarm on the space shuttle to grab hold of the telescope and move it out of the shuttle's payload bay and back into space. After distancing itself from the telescope the Atlantis fired its engines to make its return trip back to earth. But the return trip was not as simple as expected. Stormy weather over Florida made it impossible for Atlantis to land safely. So the shuttle was diverted to California. The two day delay increased the risk profile of the mission and also caused the mission to shoot up economically. The Hubble telescope, although not mankind's only telescope in space, provides scientists and space enthusiasts a lot of information about the mysteries of space. Because it is in orbit, it can take very sharp pictures of deep space without the trouble of background light – a problem that Terrestrial observatories have to deal with. It has sent to earth the most detailed visible-light images ever taken of the universe's most distant objects. Among its other achievements is accurately determining the rate of expansion of the universe. Hubble has also helped scientists find out how old the universe is – 13.7 billion years, that black holes are at the centre of most galaxies, and details of planetary formation. NASA hopes that with this latest infusion of life, the telescope will be up and running for at least the next five years. 

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Is the number of laptops that have been lost by the UK Ministry of Defense since the start of 2009